

In Git, a *branch* is a version of the project you're working on; here you can see that we're on a branch named `main` ❶. Each time you check your project's status, it should show that you're on the branch `main`. You then see that we're about to make the initial commit. A *commit* is a snapshot of the project at a particular point in time.

Git informs us that untracked files are in the project ❷, because we haven't told it which files to track yet. Then we're told that there's nothing added to the current commit, but untracked files are present that we might want to add to the repository ❸.

Adding Files to the Repository

Let's add the two files to the repository and check the status again:

```
❶ git_practice$ git add .
❷ git_practice$ git status
On branch main
No commits yet

Changes to be committed:
  (use "git rm --cached <file>..." to unstage)
❸   new file:   .gitignore
      new file:   hello_git.py

git_practice$
```

The command `git add .` adds to the repository all files within a project that aren't already being tracked ❶, as long as they're not listed in `.gitignore`. It doesn't commit the files; it just tells Git to start paying attention to them. When we check the status of the project now, we can see that Git recognizes some changes that need to be committed ❷. The label *new file* means these files were newly added to the repository ❸.

Making a Commit

Let's make the first commit:

```
❶ git_practice$ git commit -m "Started project."
❷ [main (root-commit) cea13dd] Started project.
❸ 2 files changed, 5 insertions(+)
   create mode 100644 .gitignore
   create mode 100644 hello_git.py
❹ git_practice$ git status
On branch main
nothing to commit, working tree clean
git_practice$
```

We issue the command `git commit -m "message"` ❶ to make a snapshot of the project. The `-m` flag tells Git to record the message that follows (Started